

LG Electronics

2Q26 OP beat; positive CDU business progress vs. immature robotics outlook; maintain N

Following the 2Q26 headline beat ([link](#)), management guided for an above-seasonal 3Q outlook, helped by prudent cost control at the MS and HS divisions, in our view. LGE is in a transitional period of pivoting from a B2C-centric business portfolio to an AIDC CDU/robotics manufacturer, in our view, with management highlighting NVDA certification ([link](#)) and mass-production of actuators in 2H26. The company disclosed W600bn worth of CDU order wins in 1H26, with the amount likely to reach several trillion won by year-end. Between CDU and robotics, we continue to take a conservative stance on the robotics business opportunity, given intensifying market competition and a lack of tangible business strategy. Given the downward slope in earnings in 2H26, as well as a limited robotics business opportunity, we advise investors to stay on the sidelines.

- 2Q26 earnings beat thanks to tariff refund.** LGE reported an earnings beat despite geopolitical uncertainty, with OP of W1.58tn on sales of W23.8tn (OPM : 6.6%), driven mainly by: (1) HS sales growing 7% Y/Y, with OPM at 9.7% (both above original guidance of mid-single-digit % sales growth/OPM), largely aided by LGE's two-track strategy, as well as reciprocal tariff refunds (one-off gain net of expense: W300bn, per management); and (2) MS reporting mid-teens % y-y sales growth, coupled with a mid-single-digit % OPM (vs. JPMc: 16% Y-Y and 0% OPM), on global sporting event demand. VS was better than feared, recording mid-single-digit % Y/Y sales growth, helped by continued stable growth of the infotainment business, with profitability improving due to operational efficiency. On the other hand, ES reported low-single-digit % sales growth and a high-single-digit OPM, with profitability declining YoY due to higher logistics cost. Management emphasized completion of AI DC validation toward NVDA for its 600kW CDU ([link](#)) and disclosed W600bn worth of order wins in 1H26, projected to grow to several trillions by year-end. On the robotics front, management reiterated building a robotics data factory in 2H26, with production of initial actuators under way following the completion of pilot lines.
- 3Q26 earnings outlook and CDU business as the next growth engine.** For 3Q, management guides to an above-seasonal outlook of low-teens % y-y growth with a mid-single-digit % OPM, helped by prudent cost control at the MS division (BEP margin guidance following labor restructuring and WebOS) and the VS division (high-single-digit % OPM guidance from strong order booking). Management expects the HS division to post at the high end of high-single-digit % sales growth from continued two-track and broadening subscription business with a mid-single-digit % margin. On the ES division, guidance remained conservative, at mid-single-digit % y-y top-line growth and a mid-single-digit % OPM, due mainly due to an investment burden on the CDU and robotics business. We maintain our positive view on LGE's CDU business acting as the next growth engine, more so than robotics. Management guides that the W600bn order backlog is not inclusive of big tech companies, and we expect additional order wins in 2H26E to act as a positive growth driver for the ES division in 2027 and into 2028.
- Share price outlook.** LGE's share price performance has been volatile YTD

Neutral

066570.KS, 066570 KS

Price (30 Jul 26):W147,500

Price Target (Jun-27):W190,000

Technology - Semiconductors

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(+60% vs. LGIT/LGD : +55%/-28% vs. KOSPI: +33%), mainly on robotics business initiative expectations. However, given the lingering geopolitical risks and heavy profit-taking after an overheated AI & robotics rally, the stock has corrected -61% from its peak on 1 June (vs. KOSPI -36%). In the near term, we expect the debate to shift from robotics to the CDU business acting as the next growth engine, as well as MS margin normalization. On LGE's robotics side, while initial production of actuators is under way, limited business visibility and distant major orders suggest it is too early to price in as an emerging business. Therefore, we remain Neutral on the stock and recommend investors wait on the sidelines for a better entry point.

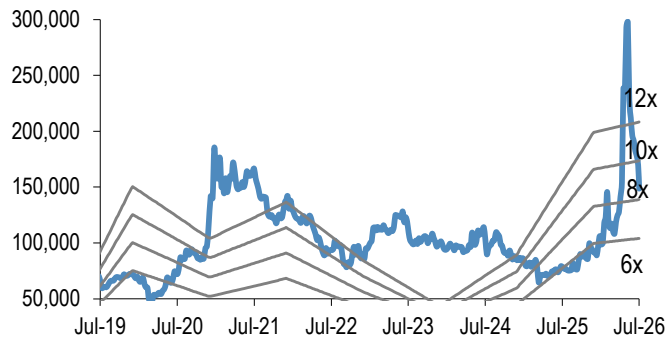
Table 1: LGE 2Q26 earnings comparison

Won in billions	2Q25	1Q26	2Q26 Actual	2Q26 JPMe	Diff. (%)	Q/Q (%)	Y/Y (%)
Sales	20,735	23,727	23,827	22,594	5.5	0.4	14.9
Home Appliance Solution	6,597	6,943	7,076	6,862	3.1	1.9	7.2
Eco Solution	2,644	2,822	2,726	2,703	0.9	-3.4	3.1
Media Entertainment Solution	4,393	5,169	5,115	4,905	4.3	-1.1	16.4
Vehicle components Solution	2,849	3,064	3,026	3,069	-1.4	-1.3	6.2
LG Innotek sales	3,796	5,424	5,419	4,756	13.9	-0.1	42.8
Others	455	304	465	300	55.1	53.2	2.3
Operating profit	639	1,674	1,579	1,074	47.0	-6	147
Margin (%)	3.1	7.1	6.6	4.8			
Home Appliance Solution	438	570	686	425	61.2	20	56
Margin (%)	6.6	8.2	9.7	6.2			
Eco Solution	251	249	236	230	2.6	-5	-6
Margin (%)	9.5	8.8	8.6	8.5			
Media Entertainment Solution	-192	372	219	2	9,262.3	-41	na
Margin (%)	-4.4	7.2	4.3	0.0			
Vehicle Components	126	212	191	246	-22.1	-10	52
Margin (%)	4.4	6.9	6.3	8.0			
LG Innotek	16	298	252	166	52.0	-15	1,506
Margin (%)	0.4	5.5	4.7	3.5			
Others	0	-26	-5	5	na	na	na
Recurring profit	762	1,401	1,239	854	n.a	-11.5	62.7
Tax	151	396	458	226	n.a	15.7	203.4
Net profit	605	816	668	464	n.a	-18.1	10.5

Source: Company data, J.P. Morgan estimates, Bloomberg Finance L.P.

Figure 1: LGE – 12M forward P/E bands

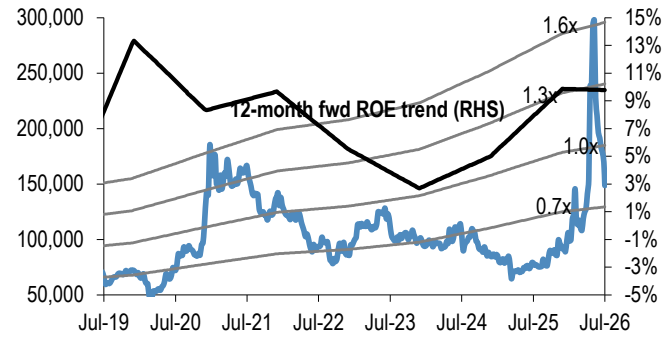
Won



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan estimates.

Figure 2: LGE – 12M forward P/BV and ROE

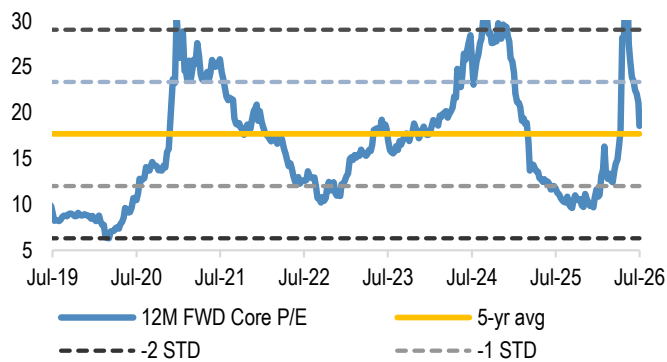
Won, %



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan estimates.

Figure 3: LGE – 12M forward core P/E multiple trend

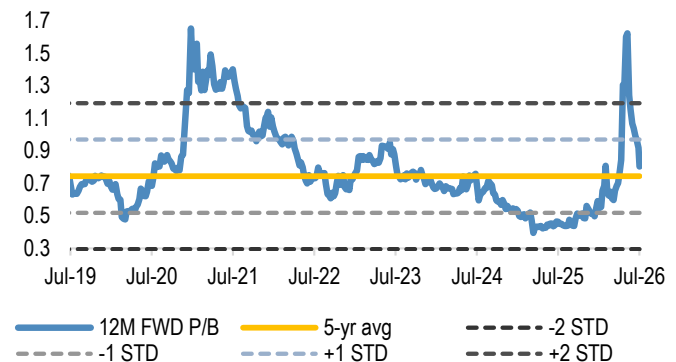
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Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan estimates

Figure 4: LGE – 12M forward P/BV multiple trend

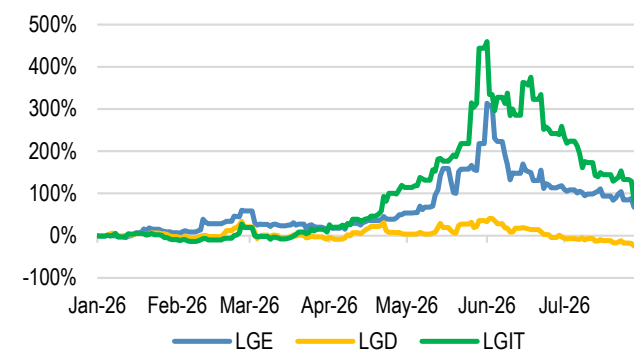
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Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan estimates

Figure 5: LGE vs. subsidiaries – YTD performance

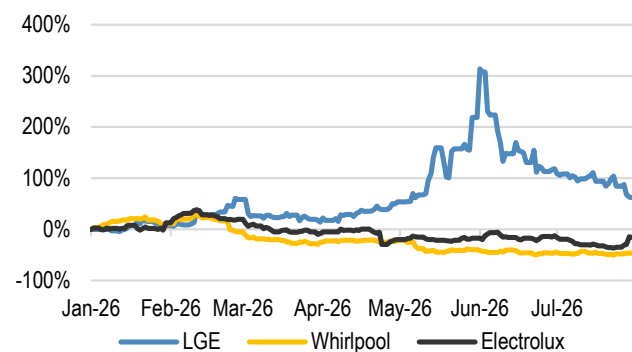
%



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. Note: Past results are not an indicator of future performance.

Figure 6: LGE vs. H&A peers – YTD performance

%



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. Note: Past results are not an indicator of future performance.

2Q26 earnings call recap – Our summary

Q. [Corporate] Following news flow on NVIDIA CEO meeting LG management, any details on ongoing collaboration with NVIDIA? What is the roadmap outlook?

A. In the robotics sector, LGE is pursuing a joint project aimed at combining its robot hardware technology with Nvidia's physical AI technology stack. By collaborating from the proof-of-concept stage, the project is targeted at robot manufacturing up to actual application. LGE is focused on advancing robot foundation models and developing simulation and verification platforms. In the AI datacenter, LGE is collaborating on the development of advanced high-density cooling technologies (Coolant Distribution Unit). The company's models of CDU received Nvidia certification, marking a meaningful milestone. For the mobility sector, the engineering teams of both companies have begun to develop an AI-based software vehicle platform. Currently, practical work is under way, and companies are conducting reviews of next-generation high-performance computing platforms.

Q. [HS] Any expectations of freight rates rising in the near term? Outlook for logistics costs for 2H26E?

A. SCFI rates have been trending higher due to geopolitical tensions. With more carriers entering the market in 2H26 and global shipping demand likely to moderate after the peak season, we will continue to renegotiate terms with carriers by leveraging large-scale volume and long-standing relationships. LGE is improving to further optimize operations to minimize logistics costs. LGE believes freight rates could peak in 3Q26, and easing market conditions could drive rates back to prior-year levels.

Q. [Robotics] Any color on commercialization of actuators? Any guidance on visibility into earning recognition and scope of partnership?

A. The 1H26 actuator pilot line has been completed and is now focused on quality testing and automation. In partnership, LGE signed an MOU in June and is considering more collaborative efforts. LGE aims to become a provider of customized solutions in robotics, not only a components provider. By integrating data platforms and AI agents, LGE targets to deliver physical AI solutions. In the newly established Robotics Business Center, LGE plans on collaborating with not only big tech companies like NVIDIA, but also with leading Chinese robotics players. Last, LGE seeks synergy across LG affiliates and portfolio companies.

Q. [Corporate] Regarding the US tariff refund, any details on how much of the refund was reflected in 2Q?

A. The company followed the refund guidance provided by the US government. LGE received a full refund in 2Q26, and net of one-time expense was approximately W300bn. While tariff concerns remain in 2H26, LGE aims to reduce volatility by leveraging supply chain optimization and flexible pricing policies.

Q. [VS] Regarding LG Magna, any details on operating status in Mexico and Hungary? And outlook during market volatility?

A. LGE is seeking to expand its revenue base beyond the NA market and has been operating in the EU and Asia. The company has secured meaningful EV powertrain order wins from Asia and EU OEMs in 1H26. This allows LGE to diversify regional exposure and reduce heavy reliance on select companies. (1) Mexico – achieved stable operations since opening in 2023 and contributing to more than 40% of total sales; (2) Hungary – key hub for Europe

localization efforts and anticipates MP in Jan-27. To address demand volatility, LGE is closely monitoring various external factors, like promotions and incentives.

Q. [ES] With high expectations for the AI datacenter chiller business, which regions are the primary target?

A. NA is the primary area for AI datacenter cooling business. IT capacity is expected to grow from 25GW in 2026 to 70GW in 2031, and more than 60% will be in NA. Hence, CSPs are the primary channel partners for chillers and liquid/cooling components. For Asia, the company seeks to expand customers by leveraging its existing track record and using the “One LG” strategy.

Q. [MS] The MS division delivered significant improvement, recording operating profit. What were the drivers to the improvement, and any guidance on outlook?

A. OP improvement was driven by a higher proportion of premium products and enhanced performance from overseas operations. In 2H26, management expects macro environment volatility and rising memory cost to affect profitability. In response, LGE will optimize strategic inventory and continue cost-efficiency initiatives. LGE expects a full year of operating profit. Over the mid- to long term, LGE aims to accelerate the growth of WebOS system and maintain a stable profitability trend.

Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

LG Electronics *(Neutral; Price Target: W190,000)*

Investment Thesis

We estimate that LGE's core NOPAT will grow at a double-digit rate throughout our forecast period, driven by stable profit improvement from core operations. However, new business initiatives are at an early stage, such that meaningful business transition is limited. Based on our mid-cycle valuation, we view the risk/reward as unfavorable at the current share price. We remain Neutral on the stock.

Valuation

Our Jun-27 PT of W190K valuation is based on 17x FY27E core NOPAT per share, in line to a mid-cycle valuation to reflect a growing AI DC grade chiller and cooling solutions business opportunity and core business cycle earnings normalization. On the other hand, we believe it is too early to give credit to the robotics business growth opportunity.

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Upside risks include: (1) stronger H&A margin expansion, driven by faster new business growth (e.g., Chiller, HVAC, and others); (2) Web OS customer diversification outside captive customers or faster end-market diversification into automotive customers; and (3) a recovery in the EV market and LGE's further vehicle-business design wins.

Downside risks include: (1) raw materials/logistics cost-related margin headwinds; (2) continued TV panel price strength resulting in further HE hardware profitability; and (3) further delays in the EV market recovery and slowing new order wins in the vehicle component business.

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LG Electronics (066570.KS, 066570 KS) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (W)	Price Target (W)
29-Aug-23	OW	99600	130,000
12-Jul-24	N	111000	120,000
25-Oct-24	N	97200	110,000
23-Jan-25	N	86400	95,000
24-Apr-25	N	71300	82,000
17-Aug-25	N	77200	80,000
04-Nov-25	N	88900	87,000
30-Apr-26	N	137400	145,000
02-Jul-26	N	192400	190,000

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
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